

Bedtime Paper for the Founder

The Real Incidence of Sudden Death in France: What Matters Before Sleep

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Prepared for: Founder (bedtime edition)

Why this paper matters

This is not a drug or treatment paper. It is a measurement paper. Its core value is helping us avoid false certainty when discussing sudden death (SD) incidence.

Source snapshot

- Title: The real incidence of sudden death: Fair estimations or futile speculations?
- Authors: Marimpouya N, Guilbeau-Frugier C, Ferrieres J, et al.
- Journal: Archives of Cardiovascular Disease (2024)
- DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.acvd.2024.01.003>
- Topic: Epidemiology of sudden death in France

The key finding in one line

Depending on method, annual SD incidence in France spans roughly **6,500 to 27,000** deaths, a wide range that reflects methodology, not random error.

The three estimation lenses

1. Resuscitated cases plus necropsies:
 - ~7,700 to 9,400 per year
2. Death certificates:
 - 6,584 per year
3. Emergency call pathways:
 - ~16,000 to 27,000 per year

Founder interpretation

- This paper is a warning against single-metric storytelling.
- Operational systems should carry uncertainty explicitly.
- Decision models should ingest ranges and provenance, not one fixed point estimate.
- Public communication should distinguish measurement frame from biological truth.

Practical implications for our stack

- Data model: keep method-tagged incidence fields.
- UI/reporting: surface confidence bands by method.
- Agent behavior: block overconfident claims when method context is missing.
- Policy: require method provenance before strategic inference.

Night note

If you only remember one thing: **the number is not the truth; the method is part of the truth**.

Sleep with this: better measurement discipline now prevents strategic drift later.

Integrity note

This bedtime paper is an executive synthesis based on the metadata and values already provided

in-session. It is not a full-text extraction.